

HOW - WHY

PRIMARY HOW · SECONDARY WHY · TERTIARY WHAT

How the HOW-WHY communicates

How your wiring shows up in writing and speech, how each orientation hears it, and the three adjustments that buy the most understanding.

HOW YOU NATURALLY WRITE

You write to get it right. Careful terms, distinguished cases, caveats where they belong, and the deeper why of how things work woven through. You correct gently and completely, and length tracks the truth. What thins out is momentum: the decision pressure, the progress claim, the date. Your reader learns exactly how things stand, and rarely when anything will move.

Your signature

PRESENT

- + Sequence and cases: "there are three scenarios here"
- + Qualifiers as structure: "assuming", "unless", "depends"
- + Mechanism plus meaning: why it works the way it does
- + Precise numbers, defined terms, named unknowns

CONSPICUOUSLY ABSENT

- Deadlines and decision pressure
- Progress claims: "shipped", "moving", "on track"
- The good-enough register
- Urgency of any kind

HOW YOU LAND

HOW readers

Hear a native speaker. Your completeness relaxes them; they build on your messages.

WHY readers

Value the depth and the patterns. They may ask you to lift the meaning to the top rather than distributing it through the piece.

WHAT readers

Respect the rigor and cannot find the status. No date and no claim of motion reads as no motion, whatever is actually happening underneath.

THE BLIND SPOT

Being right and being seen to move are different currencies, and half your readers spend the second one. Three weeks of genuinely deep work with no visible claim reads, to WHAT wiring, identical to three weeks of nothing. The broadcast you consider premature is the evidence they consider missing.

For WHAT readers

Claim the motion weekly. Four lines: shipped, moving, blocked, next, even when shipped is "nothing, deep in X, on track for the 14th". Reliability is the message.

For WHY readers

Promote the pattern. Your best insight usually lives in paragraph four; open with it and let the mechanism support it.

Everywhere

Timestamp your certainty. "Verified as of Tuesday" and "still testing" let you be precise about being unfinished, which is the honesty your wiring wants anyway.